



From phone to museum

Google's Art and Culture app puts work of more than 1000 museum in your hands
dgit.in/googleACA



Smart Sutures?

Smart sutures can monitor wounds as they heal with blood glucose, pH and body temperature levels
dgit.in/Smartsutures



Every month we recognise the best article written by our community members and publish it here. Keep up the good work, Digitians!

Making EDM with FL Studio

Do you hum your own melodies and would think of creating your own music someday? You need not wait any longer, read on and get your hands dirty with nothing but your laptop.



Praneet Sah

There are two opinions about making Electronic Dance Music, a.k.a EDM, half the population believes that all you need to do is to press a button on your computer while the other half believes that it requires heavy investment on instruments, studio and maybe some luck.

Apparently, both of these popular opinions have misguided a lot of people and might have even broken some dreams (especially if you took advice from 'Sharma Ji'). As a matter of fact, you can make tracks like 'Animals' in your home, right now. Things get tricky only when you want to include custom lyrics in your tracks, for that you indeed require a studio or at least a good mic which won't come for less than 10 Grand. Right now, we'll look at how to make music which is a central thing for any EDM. So I can tell you two things right now, making an EDM track doesn't require any physical instruments or heavy investment and the other thing is, I'd give you a million bucks if you could make a button that could generate music on its own.

Let's get into the main stuff now. There are three things that we require, firstly a good laptop with a decent CPU and as much RAM as possible. Second thing is, your song would be heard on various speaker setups and you want it to sound the same everywhere. That's why you must get a good pair of studio headphones (Sony MDR-7506 are quite famous) as they are the closest to reproducing the actual song without powering up the bass and beats. And the third thing that we require is software, in the market a lot of them are available and for this tutorial I've chosen FL Studio, probably because a lot of people seem to be using it and you can get your free trial copy from www.image-line.com.

Open up FL Studio 12 and its first look might bewilder you but unlike any other complex software, it is pretty easy to learn. Before that, have a little idea on how electronic music is made in

general. The basic unit is a 'pattern' which is pretty much like the basic beats for your song. Every melody/beat that you think is put on a pattern and then you take this (and many other) patterns on the main palette (blur colored box in the image). So, varying and repeated pattern come together to form your song. You might not actually notice but there are a lot of things that go into a song, such as Drums, Percussion, Chords, Melody, Bass and any other stuff that you might wish to put up. Things like reverb, distortion and various other effects on the sound are produced via the plugins that we'll discuss later.

I've highlighted some essential controls with the help of colored boxes as you can see in the image. Starting from the top-left corner, the purple box is basically a kind of status bar that tells you the name of various icons and numerical values



The FL Studio 12 Workspace

of settings which have knob like interface. The green box is pretty essential as it allows you to play and stop the song. The orange-colored-refresh-button lets you choose the play mode, which means, whether you want to play the whole song that you've made or just a pattern. The yellow box basically controls 'what your mouse would do on click?'. You can set it to painting, muting, slicing or selecting a pattern. It also allows you to control